Rootul Patel

Santa Cruz, CA / rootulp@gmail.com / (516) 359-5026 / rootulp.com / linkedin.com/in/rootulp

Engineering Manager leading Celestia's Protocol team, with 10 years of distributed systems experience and deep IC roots in consensus protocols and Go. Shipped seven consensus-breaking upgrades to live mainnet and now drive team-level reliability, performance, and scale objectives. Previously built Ethereum infrastructure at AWS and data platforms at Palantir.

EXPERIENCE

Celestia

Jul 2022 — Present

Engineering Manager · Mar 2026 — Present

- Lead an 8-person team owning reliability, performance, and scale for the Celestia protocol
- Set and drive Q2 OKRs across network reliability, protocol performance, and scale

Team Lead · Dec 2025 — Mar 2026

- Led a 4-person team owning the Celestia consensus layer

Senior Software Engineer · Jul 2022 — Dec 2025

- Led Celestia's first consensus-breaking upgrade (v2.0.0), establishing the framework reused by every subsequent network upgrade
- Authored 1,168 and reviewed 2,427 merged pull requests across celestia-app and celestia-core

Amazon Web Services

Jun 2020 — Apr 2022

Software Development Engineer II

- Expanded Ethereum support for Amazon Managed Blockchain to 6 AWS regions
- Recognized as employee of the month 3 times in less than 2 years (team of ~20 engineers)
- Saved our team $19K+ per month by optimizing Kinesis usage

Palantir

Aug 2016 — May 2020

Software Engineer · Aug 2017 — May 2020

- Maintained Foundry Reports, a cross-platform dashboarding application deployed to hundreds of enterprise organizations
- Developed Foundry Data Connection application that connected to external databases and systems to enable automated data pipelines into Foundry

Forward Deployed Engineer · Aug 2016 — Aug 2017

- Awarded patents: *Tools for chemical manufacturing* and *Automated risk visualization*

EDUCATION

Boston College · Carroll School of Management

B.S. in Management — Computer Science & Information Systems

Sep 2012 — May 2016

Dean's Letter of Commendation · Cum Laude · Co-president, Computer Science Society

SKILLS

LANGUAGES Go · Rust · TypeScript

DOMAINS Distributed systems · Consensus protocols

INFRASTRUCTURE AWS · Git